

Action Archive

for BigFix Platform

Installation Guide

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Archive Server	Ubuntu Server 24.04 / 26.04 LTS
Audit Agent	BigFix Root Server (Windows)
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Table of Contents

1. What's Included.....	5
2. Architecture Overview.....	6
Data Flow.....	6
3. Prerequisites.....	7
Archive Server (Ubuntu).....	7
BigFix Root Server (Windows): Audit Agent.....	7
BigFix Operator Account.....	7
4. Part 1: Archive Server Installation (Ubuntu).....	8
Step 1: Copy the Archive Package.....	8
Step 2: Extract the Package.....	8
Step 3: Run the Installer.....	9
Step 4: Enter Admin Account Details.....	11
Step 5: Enter BigFix Connection Details.....	11
Step 6: SSL Certificate Configuration.....	12
Step 7: Performance Tuning.....	12
Step 7: Installation Completes.....	13
5. Part 2: First Login and Configuration.....	14
Step 1: Open the Archive Server's Web UI.....	14
Step 2: Log In.....	14
Step 3: Configure/Verify BigFix Connection.....	15
Step 4: Run Your First Collection.....	16
Step 5: Browse Archived Actions.....	17
Step 6: Generate an API Key and Download the Audit Agent (Optional).....	19
6. Part 3: Audit Agent Installation (Windows).....	20
Step 1: Install Python (if not already installed).....	20
Step 2: Transfer the Audit Agent Package.....	20
Step 3: Run the Installer.....	20
Step 4: Enter Configuration.....	21
Step 5: Test the Connection.....	21
Step 6: Install.....	21
Step 7: Confirm the Scheduled Task.....	21
7. Verification.....	22
Archive Server.....	22
1. Verify the service is running:.....	22
2. Check the health endpoint:.....	22
3. Web UI and data:.....	22
Audit Agent (Windows).....	22
8. Troubleshooting.....	23
Archive Server.....	23
Hardened or Locked-Down Hosts (Ubuntu).....	23
Audit Agent (Windows).....	24
Log File Locations.....	24
9. Managing the Application.....	25
Service Management (Ubuntu).....	25
Database Backup (from Web UI).....	25
Audit Agent Management (Windows).....	26
Uninstalling the Audit Agent.....	26

1. What's Included

The installation package includes a single file:

File	Size	Purpose	Install On
action-archive-latest.tar.gz	~17 MB	Archive Server application + installer	Ubuntu Server

Note: The single installation file also contains the audit agent installer. The Audit Agent is optional but recommended. Without it, actions deleted from BigFix before they are collected will not be visible in the archive.

2. Architecture Overview

The diagram below illustrates how the components interact across your environment.

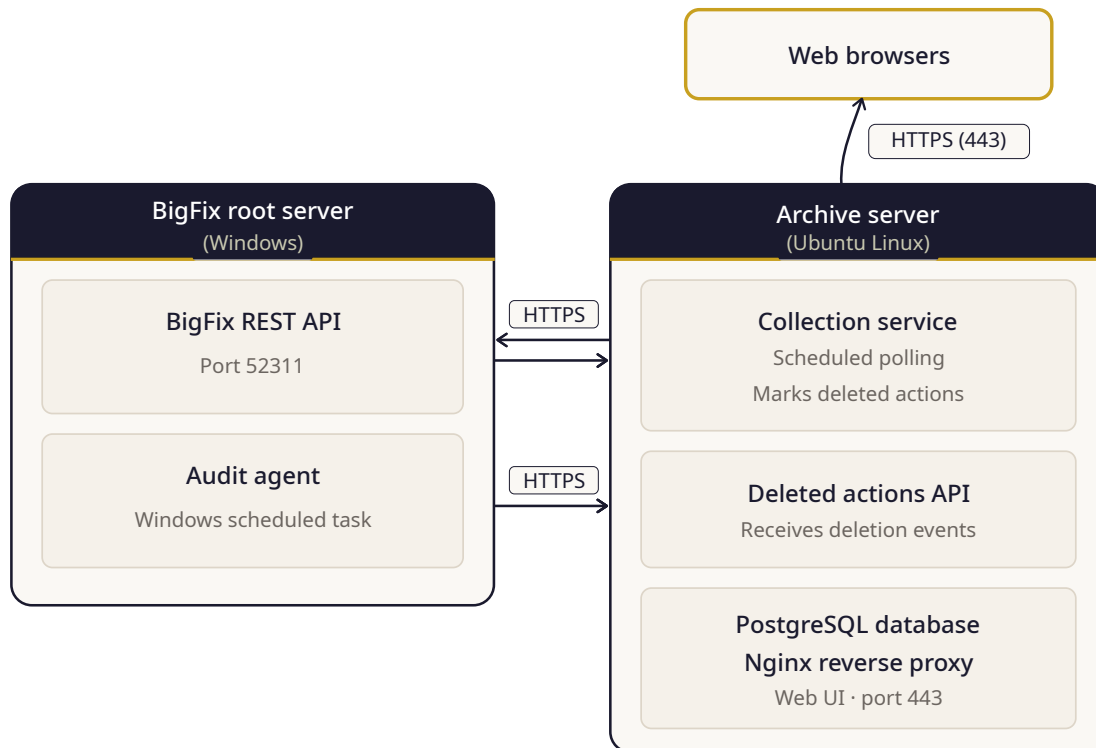


Figure 1: Action Archive System Architecture

Data Flow

- **Collection Service:** The Archive Server polls the BigFix REST API on a schedule to collect expired and stopped actions. It can also be configured to mark collected actions as 'deleted' in the console for BigFix's cleanup process to remove from the database during a cleanup run.
- **Audit Agent:** Monitors server_audit.log on the BigFix Root Server and reports any action deletions to the Archive API via HTTPS.
- **Web UI:** Users access the archive through any web browser over HTTPS (port 443).

3. Prerequisites

Archive Server (Ubuntu)

Requirement	Details
Operating System	Ubuntu Server 24.04 LTS or 26.04 LTS (amd64)
Access	Root or sudo access
CPU	2 vCPU minimum, 4 vCPU recommended (x86-64 / amd64)
RAM	Minimum 4 GB
Disk	Minimum 20 GB free
Network	Internet access during installation (for apt packages)
Network	Must be able to reach the BigFix Root Server REST API
Ports	443 (HTTPS) must be accessible to users

Note: The installer will automatically install and configure PostgreSQL, Nginx, Python, and all dependencies. You do not need to pre-install anything beyond the base Ubuntu Server. The same installer package works on both supported Ubuntu releases; it detects the host's Python version and selects the matching compiled modules automatically.

BigFix Root Server (Windows): Audit Agent

Requirement	Details
Operating System	Windows Server 2016+
Python	Python 3.8 or later (download from python.org)
PowerShell	5.1+ (included with Windows)
Network	Must be able to reach the Archive Server over HTTPS

BigFix Operator Account

The Archive Server requires a BigFix operator account to collect actions. This account must be a Master Operator (MO) to retrieve complete action data including targets and status.

Important: Master Operator is the only role that provides complete access to all action data via the BigFix REST API. A non-MO operator will result in incomplete collections. It is recommended to create a dedicated service account for this purpose. The same requirement applies whether the installer is configured for Password or API Token authentication.

4. Part 1: Archive Server Installation (Ubuntu)

Step 1: Copy the Archive Package

Copy action-archive-latest.tar.gz to your Ubuntu server (e.g., /tmp folder):

Step 2: Extract the Package

```
ssh user@your-server
cd /tmp
tar -xzf action-archive-latest.tar.gz
cd action-archive-bigfix-v1.4.0
```

You should see the following files after extraction:

```
action-archive-bigfix-v1.4.0/
  app/                # Application code
  static/             # Web frontend files
  agent/              # Bundled Audit Agent installer (Windows)
  docs/               # PDF guides and API schema
  migrations/         # Database migration scripts
  scripts/            # Helper scripts (TLS certificate setup)
  install.sh          # Automated installer
  schema.sql          # Database schema
  requirements.txt     # Python dependencies
  requirements.tested.txt # Tested dependency versions
  README.md
  THIRD-PARTY-LICENSES.md
  LICENSE
```


Step 3: Run the Installer

```
sudo bash install.sh
```

Important: If sudo is unavailable or restricted on your host, switch to root first then run 'bash install.sh'

The installer will display a banner and perform a pre-flight check to ensure all packages it needs for a successful installation are present. If any are not present, it will offer to install via apt install.

```
=====
Action Archive for BigFix Platform - Installer
Version 1.1.4
=====

[20:33:42] === Pre-flight Checks ===
Detected: Ubuntu 24.04 (noble)

[20:33:42] === Prerequisite Check ===
Found: curl
Found: python3
Found: openssl
Found: free
Found: lsblk
Found: nproc
Found: useradd
All prerequisites satisfied.
Memory: 7942MB available
Disk: 11146MB free on /opt
```

If an existing Action Archive installation is detected on this server, the installer presents an Upgrade / Reinstall / Cancel prompt. Upgrade (the default) preserves all configuration, credentials, and archived data and only refreshes the application files. Reinstall performs a fresh install and wipes existing data. Use with caution. This prompt does not appear on a first-time install.

Important: When upgrading from a version earlier than 1.5.0, the installer shows a one-time notice that this upgrade may take longer than usual because of a database column change. This is expected and happens only once. Later upgrades are not affected.

```
=====
Action Archive for BigFix Platform - Installer
Version 1.1.3
=====

[20:44:15] === Pre-flight Checks ===
Detected: Ubuntu 24.04 (noble)
Memory: 7942MB available
Disk: 10380MB free on /opt

WARNING: Action Archive for BigFix Platform is already installed (version: 1.1.2). This installer is version 1.1.3.

1) Upgrade -- Replace application code only. Preserves the .env
            file (BigFix credentials, encryption keys, all
            in-app settings), the SSL certificate, the admin
            password, and the database. Recommended.

2) Reinstall -- Start fresh. Prompts for new BigFix and admin
               credentials, regenerates .env, regenerates the
               self-signed SSL cert, and resets the admin
               password. The database itself (archived actions,
               users, audit log) is preserved either way.

3) Cancel

Choose [1, 2, or 3, default 1]:
```

Note: If you are moving an existing Action Archive deployment to a different host or migrating from Ubuntu 22.04 to 24.04 or 26.04), do not copy the .env file or database backups manually. Instead, use the Server Migration feature. It produces a single cryptographically signed and passphrase-encrypted bundle that carries the database, BigFix and SMTP credentials, and configuration across hosts safely.

The screenshot shows the 'ACTION ARCHIVE FOR BIGFIX PLATFORM v1.4.0' interface. The top navigation bar includes 'DASHBOARD', 'ACTIONS', and 'ADMINISTRATION'. The 'ADMINISTRATION' section is active, with sub-tabs for 'USER MANAGEMENT', 'SYSTEM SETTINGS', and 'LOGS'. The 'SYSTEM SETTINGS' tab is selected, showing the 'DATABASE BACKUP & RESTORE' section. This section includes a 'REFRESH' button and a 'CREATE BACKUP NOW' button. Below these is a table with columns: FILENAME, SIZE, CREATED, and ACTIONS. The table contains one entry: 'backup_20260614_031855.sql', 20.7 MB, 6/14/2026, 3:18 AM. The ACTIONS column for this entry has buttons for 'DOWNLOAD', 'RESTORE', and 'DELETE'. A red arrow points to the 'BACKUP & RESTORE' link in the left sidebar. Below the backup section is the 'SERVER MIGRATION' section, which includes an 'EXPORT FOR MIGRATION' button and an 'IMPORT MIGRATION' button. A red arrow points to the 'EXPORT FOR MIGRATION' button. The 'EXPORT FOR MIGRATION' button is highlighted with a yellow border.

ACTION ARCHIVE
FOR BIGFIX PLATFORM v1.4.0

Welcome, Administrator [MY ACCOUNT](#) [LOGOUT](#)

ADMINISTRATION

SYSTEM SETTINGS

DATABASE BACKUP & RESTORE [REFRESH](#) [CREATE BACKUP NOW](#)

Create, download, and restore full database backups. Restoring a backup will replace all current data.

FILENAME	SIZE	CREATED	ACTIONS
backup_20260614_031855.sql	20.7 MB	6/14/2026, 3:18 AM	DOWNLOAD RESTORE DELETE

SERVER MIGRATION

Move this deployment to another server in one passphrase-protected file (database, BigFix and SMTP credentials, and collection settings). Credentials are decrypted on this server, encrypted with your passphrase for transport, and re-encrypted with the target server's key on import. The master encryption key itself never leaves either server.

[EXPORT FOR MIGRATION](#) [IMPORT MIGRATION](#)

Allow unsigned (legacy) migration imports

[Disabled \(require signed exports\)](#)

Exports created by Action Archive 1.4.0 and later are digitally signed and verified on import. Older unsigned exports are rejected unless this is enabled. A signed file that fails verification is always rejected, even when this is on. Enable only to import a trusted legacy file, then disable it again.

The screenshot shows the 'EXPORT FOR MIGRATION' dialog box. It has a title bar with a close button (X). The main content area contains a warning message: 'Treat this file like a password. The passphrase you choose is the only thing protecting your BigFix and SMTP credentials in transit. If you lose the passphrase, the file cannot be recovered.' Below this is a paragraph: 'A single file (.aa-wig) will be produced containing the database and credentials, encrypted with your passphrase. Use it once on the target server, then delete it.' There are two input fields: 'PASSPHRASE' and 'CONFIRM PASSPHRASE'. The 'PASSPHRASE' field has a hint: 'At least 12 characters, mixed case, with a digit'. The 'CONFIRM PASSPHRASE' field has a hint: 'Re-enter the same passphrase'. At the bottom are two buttons: 'EXPORT MIGRATION' and 'CANCEL'.

EXPORT FOR MIGRATION [X](#)

Treat this file like a password. The passphrase you choose is the only thing protecting your BigFix and SMTP credentials in transit. If you lose the passphrase, the file cannot be recovered.

A single file (.aa-wig) will be produced containing the database and credentials, encrypted with your passphrase. Use it once on the target server, then delete it.

PASSPHRASE

At least 12 characters, mixed case, with a digit

CONFIRM PASSPHRASE

Re-enter the same passphrase

[EXPORT MIGRATION](#) [CANCEL](#)

Step 4: Enter Admin Account Details

The installer will prompt you for the initial administrator account:

- **Admin username:** The username you will use to log into the web UI (e.g., admin)
- **Admin password:** Must meet complexity requirements (minimum 8 characters, uppercase, lowercase, number, special character)
- **Admin email:** Email address for notifications and password resets. This value is optional during the install, but should be set later in the Web interface to enable admin self-service password reset and email notifications.

Step 5: Enter BigFix Connection Details

Next, the installer prompts for BigFix server connection information:

- **BigFix Server URL:** The hostname or IP of your BigFix Root Server (e.g., https://bigfix-server)
- **BigFix Server Port:** REST API port (default: 52311)
- **BigFix Authentication Method:** Choose Password (default) or API Token. API Token is new BigFix v11.0.6. It uses BigFix's native REST API token authentication (Authorization: Bearer header).
- **If Password:** enter the BigFix Operator Username (a Master Operator service account) and Password when prompted. **If API Token:** paste the token value when prompted (paste carefully; the token is encrypted at rest and cannot be retrieved later).

Tip: To mint a BigFix API token, sign in to the BigFix Console as the operator, open Tools → Manage Tokens, and create a new token. The operator must retain the REST API permission. See the Administrator Guide for details.

```
BigFix server URL (e.g., https://bigfix.company.com): https://bfrootsvr
BigFix server port [52311]:

BigFix authentication method:
  password - Operator username and password (works on all BigFix versions)
  token    - API token (BigFix 11.0.6+ only)
Authentication method (password/token) [password]:
BigFix operator username: admin
BigFix operator password: *****
Confirm BigFix operator password: *****

Testing BigFix connection to https://bfrootsvr:52311 ...
BigFix connection verified (HTTP 200).
```

Note: The installer will test the connection and display an error if it's unable to connect to the Root Server.

Step 6: SSL Certificate Configuration

The installer will ask about SSL certificates:

- **Option 1:** Generate a self-signed certificate (recommended for testing/internal use)
- **Option 2:** Provide paths to an existing certificate and key

For most installations, choose the self-signed option.

--- SSL Certificate ---

A self-signed certificate will be generated by default.
Use existing certificate? (y/N) [N]:

Step 7: Performance Tuning

The installer will auto detect the host's hardware specs and make a recommendation about tuning the database and kernel :

- **PostgreSQL:** The installer will make recommendations about tuning PostgreSQL for performance
- **Kernel Virtual Memory:** The installer will recommend a memory management setting

It is recommended to accept the tuning parameters for better application performance.

```
[20:38:33] === PostgreSQL Performance Tuning ===
```

Detected hardware:

```
Total RAM:    7942 MB (~8 GB)
CPU cores:    1
PG storage:   SSD
```

Recommended PostgreSQL settings for this server:

```
shared_buffers      = 1985MB
effective_cache_size = 4765MB
work_mem            = 16MB
maintenance_work_mem = 256MB
random_page_cost    = 1.1
effective_io_concurrency = 200
max_worker_processes = 1
max_parallel_workers = 1
max_parallel_workers_per_gather = 1
max_parallel_maintenance_workers = 1
wal_buffers         = 16MB
checkpoint_completion_target = 0.9
```

Plus kernel: vm.swappiness = 10

Apply these PostgreSQL tuning settings now? [Y/n]: y

Step 7: Installation Completes

The installer will perform the following steps automatically:

- Install system packages (PostgreSQL, Nginx, Python, Node.js)
- Create the application user and directories
- Set up the Python virtual environment and install dependencies
- Initialize the database with the schema
- Configure Nginx as a reverse proxy with SSL
- Create and start the systemd service

When complete, you will see a success message with the URL to access the application.

```
=====
Installation Complete! (v1.1.4)
=====

Access the application:
URL:      https://192.168.0.42
Username: admin
Password: (as configured during install)

Service management:
Start:    sudo systemctl start bigfix-archive
Stop:     sudo systemctl stop bigfix-archive
Restart:  sudo systemctl restart bigfix-archive
Status:   sudo systemctl status bigfix-archive
Logs:     sudo journalctl -u bigfix-archive -f

Important paths:
App:      /opt/bigfix-archive/
Config:   /opt/bigfix-archive/config/.env
Backups:  /opt/bigfix-archive/backups/
Logs:     journalctl -u bigfix-archive

Note: You are using a self-signed SSL certificate.
Your browser will show a security warning on first visit.
You can replace it via System Settings > Certificates in the web UI.
```

5. Part 2: First Login and Configuration

Step 1: Open the Archive Server's Web UI

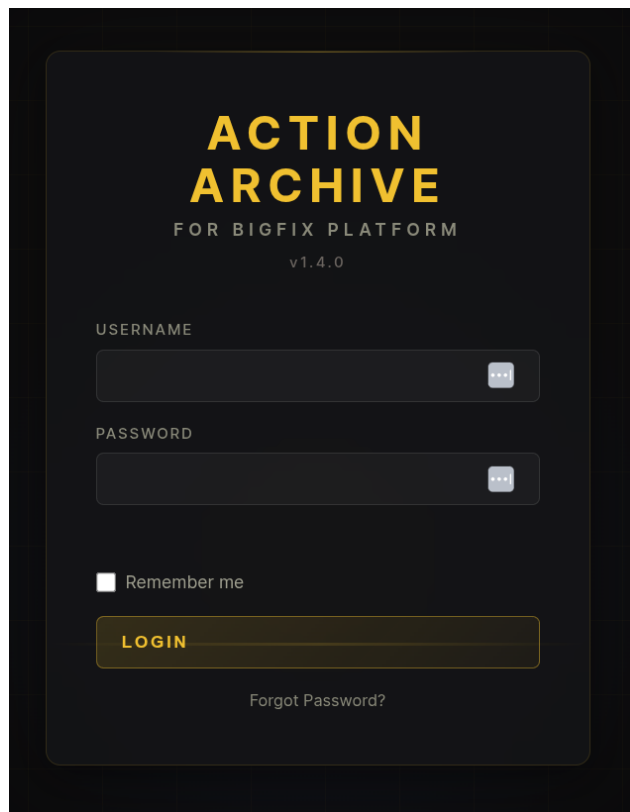
Open a web browser and navigate to the Archive Server URL:

```
https://your-server-ip
```

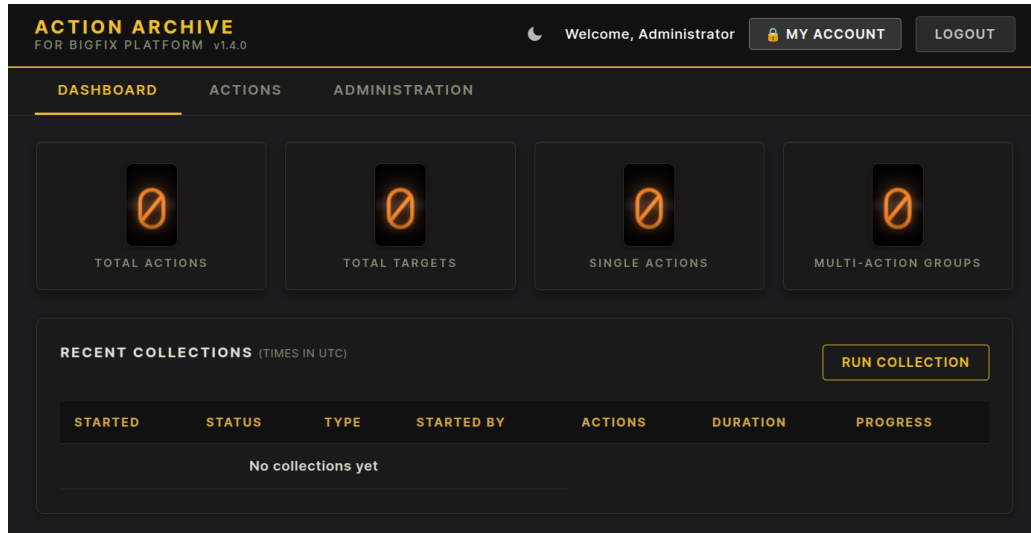
Note: If using a self-signed certificate, your browser will show a security warning.

Step 2: Log In

Enter the admin username and password you created during installation.



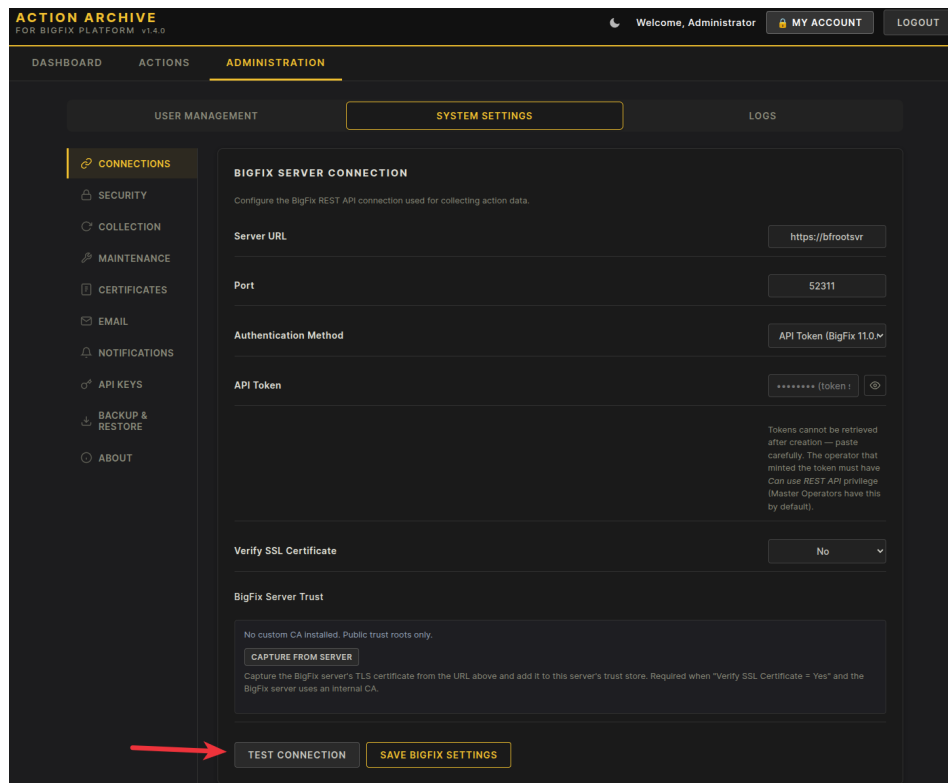
The screenshot shows the login interface for Action Archive. At the top, the text "ACTION ARCHIVE" is displayed in large, bold, yellow letters, followed by "FOR BIGFIX PLATFORM" and "v1.4.0" in smaller white text. Below this, there are two input fields: "USERNAME" and "PASSWORD", both with dark gray backgrounds and white text. Each field has a small white icon on the right side. Under the password field, there is a checkbox labeled "Remember me". At the bottom, there is a yellow button with the text "LOGIN" in black. Below the button, there is a link that says "Forgot Password?" in white text.



The dashboard should display the counters showing "0" for all statistics

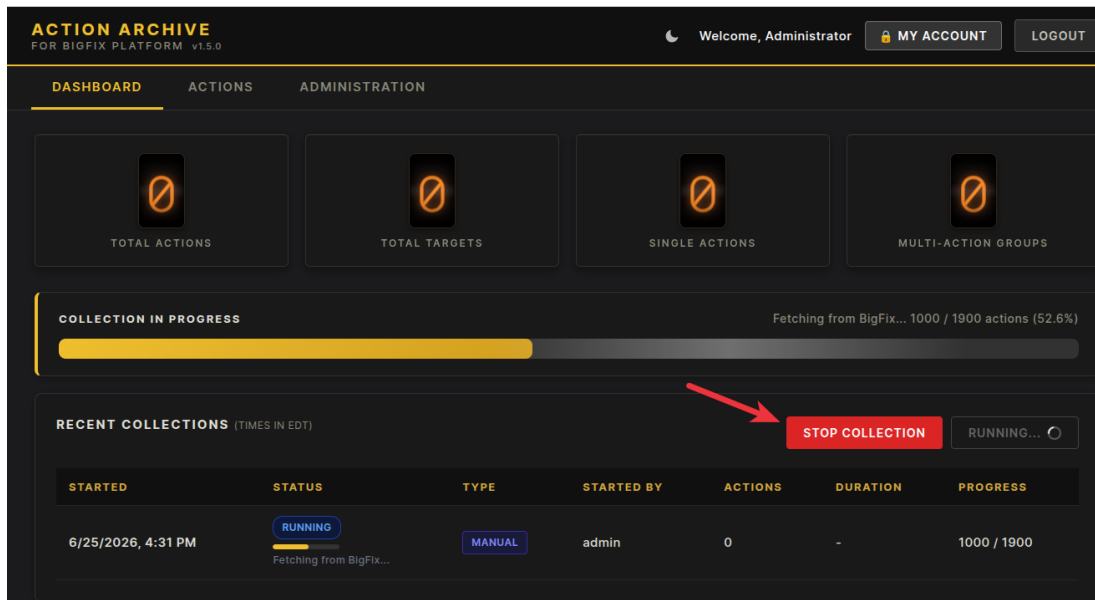
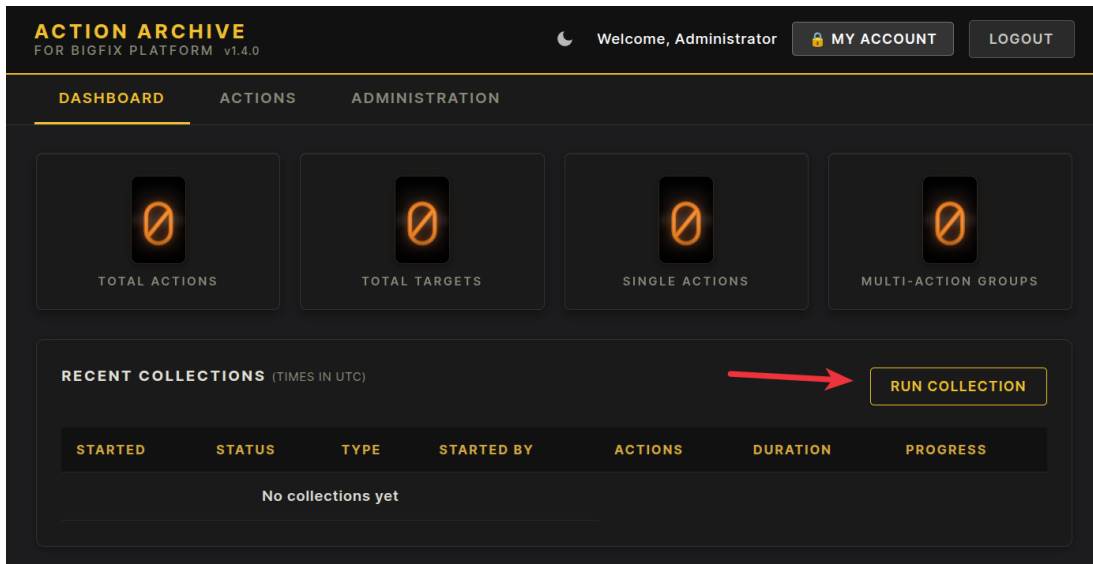
Step 3: Configure/Verify BigFix Connection

Navigate to Administration > System Settings > Connections to verify the BigFix server connection is correct. Click Test Connection to confirm the Archive can reach your BigFix REST API.

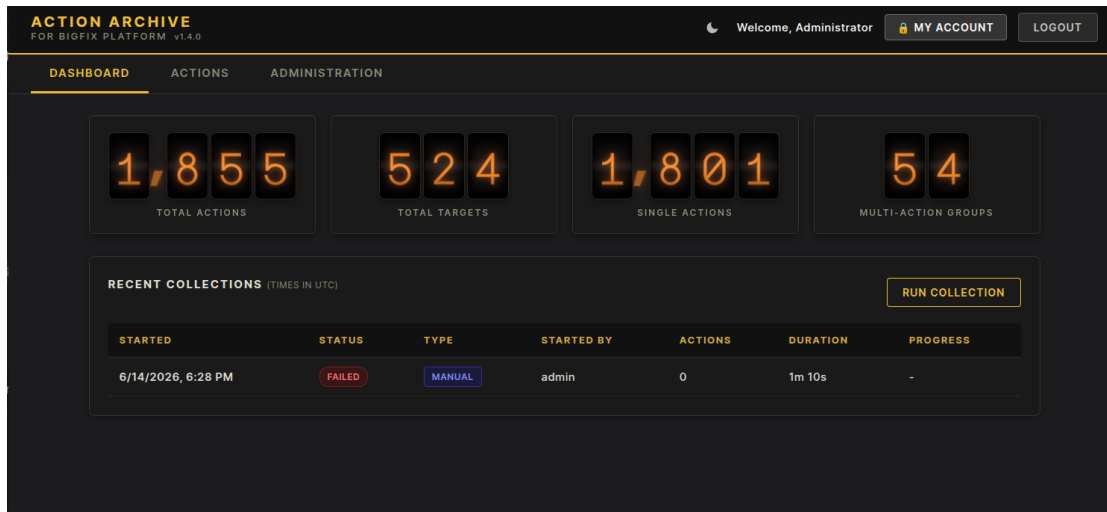


Step 4: Run Your First Collection

- Go to the Dashboard and click the **Run Collection** button to run an immediate collection



The collection progress bar will show the status of both parts of the collection (Fetching / Inserting). You can interrupt the collection by clicking the "STOP COLLECTION" button which only appears during a collection action.



After the collection completes the dashboard will show the totals and the collection status

Step 5: Browse Archived Actions

After the first collection completes, navigate to the Actions tab to see your archived actions.

ACTION ARCHIVE
FOR BIGFIX PLATFORM v1.4.0

Welcome, Administrator [MY ACCOUNT](#) [LOGOUT](#)

DASHBOARD **ACTIONS** ADMINISTRATION

ARCHIVED ACTIONS DELETED BEFORE ARCHIVED

Search actions... [All Sites](#) [All Issuers](#) [All Types](#) [All Status](#) [Console: Any](#) [CLEAR](#) [EXPORT](#)

ID	NAME	SITE	ISSUER	TYPE	STATUS	ISSUED	ARCHIVED	TARGETS
19086	Windows Critical Patches	ActionSite	mconsuegra	MAG	STOPPED	6/12/2026, 9:06 PM	6/14/2026, 6:29 PM	3
19128	MS17-AUG: Security update for SQL Server 2014 - SQ...	Master Operator Site	mconsuegra	SINGLE	STOPPED	6/12/2026, 9:06 PM	6/14/2026, 6:29 PM	3
19130	MS21-JAN: Security update for SQL Server 2019 CU8 ...	Master Operator Site	mconsuegra	SINGLE	STOPPED	6/12/2026, 9:06 PM	6/14/2026, 6:29 PM	3
19129	MS21-JAN: Security update for Secure Boot DBX - Wi...	Master Operator Site	mconsuegra	SINGLE	STOPPED	6/12/2026, 9:06 PM	6/14/2026, 6:29 PM	3
19127	ADV200013: Security Advisory: Workaround for Addre...	Master Operator Site	mconsuegra	SINGLE	STOPPED	6/12/2026, 9:06 PM	6/14/2026, 6:29 PM	3
19126	MS16-070: Security Update for Microsoft Office - V...	Master Operator Site	mconsuegra	SINGLE	STOPPED	6/12/2026, 9:06 PM	6/14/2026, 6:29 PM	3
19125	3125869: Vulnerability in Internet Explorer could ...	Master Operator Site	mconsuegra	SINGLE	STOPPED	6/12/2026, 9:06 PM	6/14/2026, 6:29 PM	3

Click an action to view its details.

WINDOWS CRITICAL PATCHES

ACTION INFORMATION

ACTION ID

19086

TYPE

MAG

STATUS

STOPPED

SITE

ActionSite

ISSUER

mconsuegra

ARCHIVED

6/14/2026, 6:29 PM

ACTION TIMELINE

ISSUED

6/12/2026, 9:06 PM

TARGET SUMMARY

3 TOTAL

2 COMPLETED

0 FAILED

0 PENDING

0 NOT RELEVANT

0 NOT REPORTED

RELEVANCE

(version of client ≥ "6.0.0.0") AND (exists true whose (if true then (exists (operating system) whose (it as string as lowercase contains "Win" as lowercase)) else false))

MEMBER ACTIONS (44)

ID	NAME	STATUS	TARGETED	COMPLETED	FAILED	ACTIONS
19087	Modify Reg Key	STOPPED	3	2	0	View
19088	MS16-027: Security Update for Windows Media to Add...	STOPPED	3	0	0	View
19089	MS19-FEB: Security Only Quality Update - Security	STOPPED	3	0	0	View
...						
	MS19-MAR: Security					

Step 6: Generate an API Key and Download the Audit Agent (Optional)

If you plan to install the Audit Agent (Part 3), both the API key and the agent installer package are obtained from the same panel of the web UI. No internet access is required. The agent installer is served from local disk on the Archive Server.

- Navigate to Administration > System Settings > API Keys
- Click Generate New Key
- Enter a name (e.g., "BigFix Audit Agent")
- Click Generate Key

Copy the generated key value immediately (it will not be shown again) and save it somewhere safe; you will paste it into the agent's installer in Part 3.

On the same API Keys panel, click Download Audit Agent to save action-archive-audit-agent-latest.zip to your local machine. You will transfer this file to the BigFix Root Server in Part 3.

The screenshot shows the 'ACTION ARCHIVE FOR BIGFIX PLATFORM v1.4.0' web interface. The user is logged in as 'Administrator'. The navigation menu on the left includes 'DASHBOARD', 'ACTIONS', 'ADMINISTRATION' (selected), 'USER MANAGEMENT', 'SYSTEM SETTINGS', and 'LOGS'. Under 'ADMINISTRATION', the 'API KEYS' section is active. It features a 'GENERATE NEW KEY' button and a description: 'Manage API keys used by external agents (e.g., BigFix Audit Agent) to authenticate with the Archive API. Keys are shown only once when created - store them securely.' Below this, there is a card for 'BigFix Audit Agent' with a 'DOWNLOAD AUDIT AGENT' button. A table lists the generated keys:

NAME	KEY PREFIX	CREATED	LAST USED	STATUS	ACTIONS
BigFixAuditAgentAPI-2604	aa-2315d8a...	6/2/2026, 9:59 AM	6/12/2026, 5:00 PM	ACTIVE	REVOKE DELETE
BigFixAuditAgent-April2026	aa-9b5f317...	4/7/2026, 9:23 AM	4/17/2026, 9:14 AM	REVOKED	REACTIVATE DELETE

Important: Copy the displayed key immediately. It will only be shown once and cannot be retrieved later.

6. Part 3: Audit Agent Installation (Windows)

The Audit Agent is installed on the BigFix Root Server (Windows). It monitors the BigFix server_audit.log file for action deletions and reports them to the Archive Server.

Step 1: Install Python (if not already installed)

- Download Python 3.8 or later from python.org
- Run the installer

IMPORTANT: Check the box "Add python.exe to PATH" on the first installer screen.

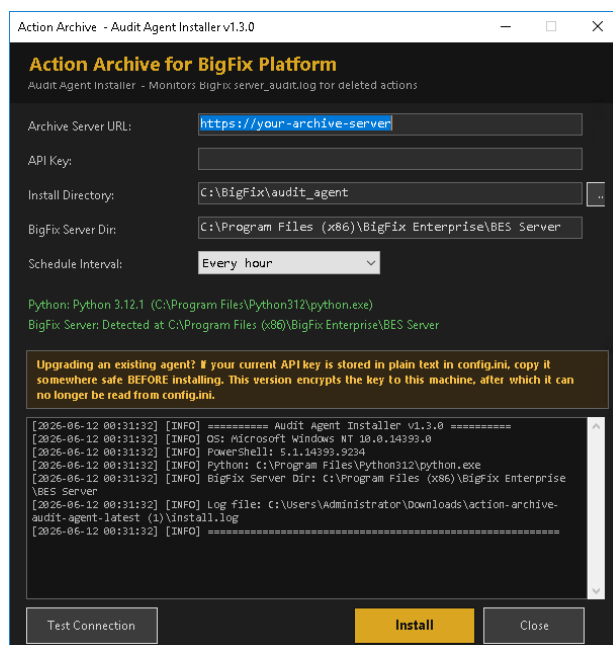
Step 2: Transfer the Audit Agent Package

Transfer action-archive-audit-agent-latest.zip (downloaded in Part 2, Step 6) to the BigFix Root Server and extract it. You can place it anywhere (e.g., C:\Temp\ or the Desktop). If you did not download the agent in Part 2, sign in to the Archive web UI now and download it from Administration → System Settings → API Keys → Download Audit Agent.

Step 3: Run the Installer

- Navigate to the extracted folder
- **Double-click** Install.bat

Note: If prompted by Windows SmartScreen or UAC, click "Run Anyway" / "Yes" to allow the installer to run. The installer requires Administrator privileges to create the scheduled task.



The installer GUI will appear:

Step 4: Enter Configuration

Fill in the following fields in the installer:

Field	Value	Notes
Archive Server URL	https://your-archive-server-ip	Must include https://
API Key	The key generated in Part 2, Step 6	Paste the full key starting with aa-
Install Directory	C:\BigFix\audit_agent	Default is fine for most environments
BigFix Server Dir	Auto-detected	Only change if BigFix is installed to a non-default location
Schedule Interval	Every hour	Configurable

Step 5: Test the Connection

Click Test Connection to verify the Archive Server URL and API Key are correct.

If the connection fails, verify:

- The Archive Server URL is correct and reachable from this server
- The API key was copied correctly (starts with aa-)
- The API key was generated on the Archive Server you are connecting to (keys are server-specific)

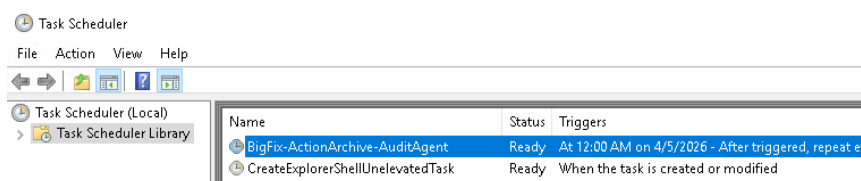
Step 6: Install

Click the Install button. The installer will perform the following steps:

- Create the install directory
- Copy agent scripts
- Generate config.ini with your settings
- Install the Python requests library
- Test the API connection
- Create a Windows Scheduled Task
- Run a historical scan of ALL server_audit.log files to catch past deletions
- Set the position marker for ongoing monitoring

Step 7: Confirm the Scheduled Task

Open Windows Task Scheduler and verify the task BigFix-ActionArchive-AuditAgent exists and is enabled.



7. Verification

After completing both installations, verify everything is working correctly.

Archive Server

1. Verify the service is running:

```
sudo systemctl status bigfix-archive
```

Should show active (running).

2. Check the health endpoint:

```
curl -sk https://localhost/api/health | python3 -m json.tool
```

Should return "status": "healthy" with all checks passing.

3. Web UI and data:

- Open <https://your-server-ip> in a browser and confirm you can log in
- Navigate to the Actions tab; it should show archived actions after a collection run

Audit Agent (Windows)

- **Scheduled task:** Open Task Scheduler and confirm BigFix-ActionArchive-AuditAgent is present
- **Agent log:** Check C:\BigFix\audit_agent\agent.log for successful runs
- **API Key activity:** In the Archive web UI, go to Settings > API Keys and verify the "Last Used" timestamp has updated
- **Deleted actions:** If any actions have been deleted from BigFix, they should appear in the Archive. You can test by deleting a test action from the BigFix Console, waiting for the next agent run, and checking the Archive.

8. Troubleshooting

Archive Server

Symptom	Likely Cause	Solution
Service fails to start	Configuration error	<code>sudo journalctl -u bigfix-archive -n 50</code>
"502 Bad Gateway" in browser	App not running or Nginx misconfigured	Verify service: <code>sudo systemctl status bigfix-archive</code>
Collection returns 0 actions	Operator is probably not a Master Operator	Verify MO status in BigFix Console
SSL certificate warning	Self-signed certificate in use	Expected for self-signed certs; proceed past the warning
Cannot reach BigFix server	Network or firewall issue	Verify: <code>curl -sk https://bigfix-server:52311</code>
Database connection error	PostgreSQL not running	<code>sudo systemctl status postgresql</code>

Hardened or Locked-Down Hosts (Ubuntu)

Symptom	Likely Cause	Solution
Pre-flight reports archive.ubuntu.com or pypi.org unreachable	Outbound network egress is blocked; the installer needs apt and pip access	Allow outbound 443 to archive.ubuntu.com, security.ubuntu.com, apt.postgresql.org, pypi.org, and files.pythonhosted.org, plus DNS. Or set <code>http_proxy</code> and <code>https_proxy</code> and use internal mirrors.
apt-get update fails: the file:/mnt/iso repository no longer has a Release file	A leftover ISO based apt source remains after the install ISO was unmounted	Locate it with <code>grep -rIn /mnt/iso /etc/apt/</code> , rename the offending .list file to .disabled, then run <code>apt-get update</code> again.
Install aborts at Configuring PostgreSQL with 'root is not in the sudoers file', or login returns 500 with 'password authentication failed for user bigfixapp'	Hardened sudoers, or sudo mounted noexec, blocks the database setup when the installer is launched through sudo	Run the installer as root directly instead of through sudo: run <code>su -</code> , then <code>bash install.sh</code> . Database steps use <code>runuser</code> , which does not depend on sudo.

Symptom	Likely Cause	Solution
Running psql as the postgres user fails with 'Permission denied' from the install directory	/opt/bigfix-archive is not readable by the postgres user, and a process cannot start from a directory it cannot enter	Run the command from a neutral directory, for example run <code>cd /tmp</code> first.

Audit Agent (Windows)

Symptom	Likely Cause	Solution
requests library not installed	pip failed during install	Run: <code>pip install requests</code> manually
Connection test fails	SSL or network issue	Verify Archive URL is reachable by opening it in a browser
API key rejected	Key mismatch or wrong server	Generate a new key on the correct Archive server
Agent runs but finds nothing	No deletions since last scan	Normal behavior: agent only reports new deletions
"Access denied" on scheduled task	Not running as Administrator	Right-click Install.bat > Run as Administrator
Historical scan found 0 deletions	No actions have been deleted	Normal if no one has deleted actions from BigFix

Log File Locations

Component	Log Location
Archive Server application	<code>sudo journalctl -u bigfix-archive</code>
Archive Server Nginx	<code>/var/log/nginx/bigfix-archive-error.log</code>
Audit Agent installer	install.log (in the extracted folder)
Audit Agent runtime	<code>C:\BigFix\audit_agent\agent.log</code>

9. Managing the Application

Service Management (Ubuntu)

```
# Check status
sudo systemctl status bigfix-archive

# Restart the service
sudo systemctl restart bigfix-archive

# Stop the service
sudo systemctl stop bigfix-archive

# View recent logs
sudo journalctl -u bigfix-archive -n 100

# Follow logs in real-time
sudo journalctl -u bigfix-archive -f
```

Database Backup (from Web UI)

- Navigate to Administration > System Settings > Backup & Restore
- Click Create Backup
- Download the backup file for off-site storage

The screenshot shows the Action Archive web interface for BigFix Platform v1.4.0. The user is logged in as an Administrator. The navigation menu on the left includes Dashboard, Actions, Administration, Connections, Security, Collection, Maintenance, Certificates, Email, Notifications, API Keys, Backup & Restore (highlighted), and About. The main content area is titled 'ADMINISTRATION' and contains three tabs: USER MANAGEMENT, SYSTEM SETTINGS, and LOGS. The SYSTEM SETTINGS tab is active, showing the 'DATABASE BACKUP & RESTORE' section. This section has a 'REFRESH' button and a 'CREATE BACKUP NOW' button. Below these is a table with columns: FILENAME, SIZE, CREATED, and ACTIONS. The table contains one entry: 'backup_20260614_031855.sql' with a size of 20.7 MB and a creation time of 6/14/2026, 3:18 AM. The ACTIONS column for this entry has buttons for 'DOWNLOAD', 'RESTORE', and 'DELETE'. A red arrow points to the 'CREATE BACKUP NOW' button, and another red arrow points to the 'DOWNLOAD' button. Below the table is the 'SERVER MIGRATION' section, which includes an 'EXPORT FOR MIGRATION' button and an 'IMPORT MIGRATION' button. A dropdown menu for 'Allow unsigned (legacy) migration imports' is set to 'Disabled (require signed exports)'.

ACTION ARCHIVE
FOR BIGFIX PLATFORM v1.4.0

Welcome, Administrator MY ACCOUNT LOGOUT

DASHBOARD ACTIONS **ADMINISTRATION**

USER MANAGEMENT **SYSTEM SETTINGS** LOGS

DATABASE BACKUP & RESTORE REFRESH CREATE BACKUP NOW

Create, download, and restore full database backups. Restoring a backup will replace all current data.

FILENAME	SIZE	CREATED	ACTIONS
backup_20260614_031855.sql	20.7 MB	6/14/2026, 3:18 AM	DOWNLOAD RESTORE DELETE

SERVER MIGRATION

Move this deployment to another server in one passphrase-protected file (database, BigFix and SMTP credentials, and collection settings). Credentials are decrypted on this server, encrypted with your passphrase for transport, and re-encrypted with the target server's key on import. The master encryption key itself never leaves either server.

EXPORT FOR MIGRATION IMPORT MIGRATION

Allow unsigned (legacy) migration imports

Disabled (require signed exports)

Exports created by Action Archive 1.4.0 and later are digitally signed and verified on import. Older unsigned exports are rejected unless this is enabled. A signed file that fails verification is always rejected, even when this is on. Enable only to import a trusted legacy file, then disable it again.

Audit Agent Management (Windows)

```
# View task status
Get-ScheduledTask -TaskName "BigFix-ActionArchive-AuditAgent"

# Run manually
Start-ScheduledTask -TaskName "BigFix-ActionArchive-AuditAgent"

# Disable temporarily
Disable-ScheduledTask -TaskName "BigFix-ActionArchive-AuditAgent"

# Re-enable
Enable-ScheduledTask -TaskName "BigFix-ActionArchive-AuditAgent"
```

Uninstalling the Audit Agent

Use the installer GUI: double-click Install.bat, then click the Uninstall button. This removes the scheduled task and all agent files.

